AUSTIN SONNY STETHEM

Pricing & Margin Analysis · Master Data & ERP · Reporting, Forecasting & Process Improvement
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Pricing and master data analyst for an 80-branch, 8-state distributor (1M+ SKUs, 565+ manufacturer lines, roughly 27,000 B2B accounts) whose revenue grew 182% since 2021, from about $152M to about $429M, on a pricing team that has been the same three people since my hire. I bring solutions, scaling and growth: I find the expensive problems aggregate reporting hides, turn complex financial data into insights and recommendations, build the SQL reporting, dashboards and forecasting models that fix them, and take them to executive leadership for decisions, with a track record that includes a costing model leadership approved as the replacement costing method. Cross-functional partner to sales, accounting, IT, logistics and product; relocating to the Minneapolis/St. Paul metro.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Working Style: Proactive, detail-oriented problem solving in a fast-paced environment; white-glove customer service to internal and external customers; influence through evidence with sales, product, accounting and IT
FP&A & Financial Analysis: Data analysis, forecasting, budgeting, variance analysis, scenario and sensitivity modeling, financial modeling, KPI scorecards, profitability and COGS analysis, business cases, business partnering and decision support
Pricing & Commercial: Pricing strategy, margin analysis, competitive analysis and market research, discount and override governance, procurement and sourcing support, vendor management
Data & Process: Data governance and quality, data modeling and DAX (coursework), data warehouse reporting, item lifecycle, inventory control, process improvement, internal controls, project management (Agile, iterative), change and stakeholder management, executive presentations
Tools: Expert Excel (Power Query, XLOOKUP), SQL, Python, Power BI (certified), Tableau (certified), Phocas BI, PowerPoint, Autopart ERP, Oracle NetSuite Foundations, Microsoft Copilot and AI-assisted analysis

EXPERIENCE

Arnold Motor Supply (Merrill Company) — Spencer, Iowa
Pricing & Master Data Analyst, reporting to the VP of Product & Pricing — October 2021 to Present

Pricing & Margin

- **Margin leakage exposed:** pulled twelve months of transactions on the highest-volume part and found 400+ distinct prices against an eight-tier ladder, a 104% spread from unmanaged overrides and legacy discounts; built the reporting and controls that keep it in front of leadership.
- **Margin held on every deal:** act as the deal desk for branch managers and sales, who bring one-off pricing, bulk discounts and freight requests daily; model the real margin and approve or decline each, and price fleet quotes and state and municipal RFPs from cross-market competitor margins and cost history.

Master Data & ERP

- **Master data at scale:** one of three people with root-level ERP access to audit, modify and deploy enterprise pricing across 80 branches; maintain the item master, cleanse and map vendor files of 100,000+ lines, and create master data for each new part, pricing it inside the 26-level, 5-region structure on day one.
- **Acquisitions integrated:** owned master data and pricing on roughly twenty store and warehouse acquisitions while revenue grew 182%: part numbers built out, rebate structures loaded, pricing matrices set, customer accounts merged onto our terms.

Reporting, BI & Forecasting

- **Manual reporting automated:** replaced manual spreadsheet audits with SQL-driven reporting in the company BI platform, including automated 12-month rolling usage variance reports; compare sales, units and margin to prior years in Phocas BI by branch, product group and SKU to track operational performance; built lost-sales dashboards in Excel and Power Query that separate fulfillment failures from pricing discrepancies.
- **Costing method replaced:** on my own initiative, built a Python Monte Carlo model forecasting landed cost per SKU over 10,000 runs (P50, P75, P95), with freight by route, utility overhead and velocity tiers; approved by the President and Lead Managing Partner as a full replacement for the prior costing method, now expanding by product group.
- **Variance and P&L impact:** run 12-month rolling cost and usage variance against plan in SQL with written driver commentary; model the P&L impact of supplier cost changes and the margin impact of each price change before it deploys.

Inventory & Supply Chain

- **Inventory and supply chain:** partnered with IT to design, test and deploy an automated rolling cycle count system in the ERP, now active; work the annual wall-to-wall physical inventory of a 148,000-plus square-foot warehouse. Earlier, handled inventory reconciliation: receiving checked against purchase orders, vendor returns, quarantine and put-away.

Projects & Process Improvement

- **Requirements to sign-off:** run cross-functional discovery with department heads across accounting, sales, IT, logistics and product to gather business requirements; map current against future state, write the spec and documentation, and carry it through UAT, then drive adoption across 80 branches with targeted training, effectively communicating each change.
- **Growth targeting:** on my own initiative, geocoded 3,768 competitor locations and roughly 32,000 customer ship-to points in Python; in use by the President and VP of Sales for greenfield siting and acquisition targeting.

CONSULTING

- **Independent consulting:** paid engagement with a spa and skin care business: built a custom bookkeeping tool covering its finances and product lines, priced its service and product offerings, and built the budgets and forecasts for employee pay and benefits.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Iowa Lakes Community College — Emmetsburg, IA
Associate of Science, coursework in agricultural sciences and chemistry · Associate of Arts, coursework in accounting, statistics and economics

Certifications
Power BI Fundamentals (Corporate Finance Institute) · Introduction to Business Analytics (Tableau Learning Partner) · Google Project Management Certificate (in progress) · W3Schools Data Science and SQL Developer · Oracle NetSuite Foundations